

Crossing to safety:
a city of few crashes

Traffic steps cut fatalities to zero in Somerville

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — Chelsea Quenneville can still recall Union Square as it was a decade ago: a chaotic crossing with cars and bikes barreling along four lanes of Somerville Avenue — a virtual “free-for-all.”

But Monday, she sat at a shaded outdoor table in a commercial hub transformed. Traffic was restricted to one lane in either direction, slowed by con-

crete refuge islands. Pedestrians walked along a raised crosswalk adorned with flashing lights. Down the block, there were new cutouts for drop-off zones, accessible parking, and an extended curb that bulged 10 feet into Walnut Street.

“It should be like this,” Quenneville said.

Union Square is but one of the busy places Somerville has sought to make safer for pedestrians, motorists, and cyclists alike. Its efforts yielded results almost unheard of in any urban area, much less the most densely populated city in New England: No one has died in a traffic collision.

SOMERVILLE, Page A13

WHY MASS. LOST ITS MOJO — AND HOW WE GET IT BACK

On the left coast, a surprising
turn on affordable housing

San Francisco relaxes demands on developers to boost construction

Third in a series

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

SAN FRANCISCO — Out here, in another coastal city plagued by inequality and starved for new home construction, officials are trying an approach to affordable housing that may sound counterintuitive: Reduce how much of it de-

velopers are required to build.

Like Boston, San Francisco has spent years deep in a housing crisis, with thousands facing homelessness and rising costs pushing even well-paid workers farther out to the suburbs. Now, as the city claws its way out of an “urban doom loop” under a new mayor, it is drastically lowering the share of affordable housing that de-

velopers must build as part of their market-rate projects, in the hope that more housing will be built overall.

The plan — paired with major new city spending on dedicated affordable housing units — underscores how desperation is prompting some left-wing strongholds to make surprising compromises. Ostensibly liberal San Francisco has built a coalition that is willing to experiment, even if it means rejecting some closely held progressive ideas.

“We can’t afford to be reactive in this moment,” said Leigh Lutenski, the city’s director of development. “We need to be, as a city, doing everything we possibly can to tackle this housing crisis.”

Developers say inclusionary requirements — which mandate building a certain amount of affordable housing alongside market-rate units — discourage new construction by making it less profitable to build. Investors get a lower return when

HOUSING, Page A14

A celebrated Dutch art collection was broken up during WWII, some of it going to the Nazis. Two of the artworks wound up in the Boston area. In April, the Harvard Art Museums agreed to return its holding, a small drawing attributed to Rembrandt. The second is held in a vault at the Museum of Fine Arts, which is awaiting the outcome of a related restitution case unfolding slowly in the Netherlands.



Above: Herri Met De Bles, “Landscape with Burning City,” which an art dealer sold to the MFA using doctored papers

Left: Rembrandt van Rijn, “Portrait of a Man,” returned by the Harvard Art Museums in April

A disputed artwork
and the push to rectify
a historical crime

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

Deep inside a vast storage vault at the Museum of Fine Arts is a tiny Flemish painting, a 16th-century artwork that has been largely unseen and undisturbed for most of the last 80 years.

The painting, “Landscape with Burning City,” by Herri Met De Bles, depicts a lone traveler fleeing a city in flames. The cruel irony is how the image mirrors the painting’s own extraordinary journey.

Just 5 inches tall, the Met De Bles picture was once part of a celebrated European collection amassed in the early 20th century. Later subsumed by the Nazi war machine, it found its way into Hermann Göring’s infamous collection of looted art, which he later spirited away by train as Allied forces closed in. Presumably intercepted by the Allies, the painting vanished amid the tumultuous liberation of Europe.

PAINTING, Page A13

GLOBE STAFF PHOTO ILLUSTRATION; ADOBE STOCK, PHOTOS BY MUSEUM OF FINE ARTS, BOSTON; MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

If you spend any time at live events, you’ve likely seen a noticeable shift in audience behavior as people appear more willing to test the boundaries of what used to be considered basic public etiquette. What’s going on? **Art+Life, N1.**

The Berkshires can read as a seasonal playground for the elite, but that’s not the whole story. **Travel, N11.**

Paying early child care workers \$6 more an hour could significantly increase formal child care enrollment, a Harvard professor says. **Metro, B1.**

When LIV Golf crashed head-first into the PGA Tour, its intention was clear: to crush golf’s establishment. Five years in, however, it’s LIV that is flat on its back, writes Tara Sullivan. **Sports, C1.**

Sol, mate

Sunday: Sunny, breezy. High: 76-81. Low: 66-71.
Monday: Cloudy, humid. High: 72-77. Low: 63-68.
Complete report, **A22.**
Deaths, **A16-20.**

Sequels not living up to the originals
Second acts by Brady, Belichick not wowing the crowds

By Mark Shanahan
GLOBE STAFF

Someday there will be a documentary about who Tom Brady and Bill Belichick used to be.

It’ll open with clips of the rogues they’ve become: Brady shilling for a Saudi-backed flag football venture, a cryptocurrency exchange, a sports gambling site; Belichick arm in arm with a pageant contestant young enough to be his granddaughter; Brady slapping an influencer in the face, perhaps as a prelude to climbing into the ring as a WWE wrestler; Belichick looking miserable and overmatched as the coach of a third-rate college football team.

The montage will be tough to watch, but it can’t be cringier than witnessing the metamorphosis of Brady and Belichick in real time. Twenty-five years on from the Patriots’ first Super Bowl victory, the team’s former QB and coach have mutated in ways that are starting to obscure — maybe

BRADY AND BELICHICK, Page A9



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Tom Brady and Bill Belichick (pictured at Gillette Stadium in 2014) won their first Super Bowl together 25 years ago.

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